WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital with Emerging & Frontier Markets

SAINT VINCENT AND THE GRENADINES

Americas

Information current as of October 2026

Dialogue | Trust | Partnership

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Kingstown	Capital and commercial centre, now served by the new Kingstown Port, which opened in October 2025 after an EC$720 million modernisation backed by the CDB and the UK Caribbean Infrastructure Fund	Port logistics, trade, financial and professional services
Argyle International Airport (east coast)	The country's international gateway, with nonstop services from the US, Canada and the UK that underpinned record stayover arrivals in 2025	Tourism, air logistics, hospitality services
Buccament Bay / Mt Wynne (leeward coast)	Home to Sandals Saint Vincent, which opened in March 2024, and the planned 500-room, $500 million Beaches resort at Mt Wynne, with design work under way from 2026	Resort tourism, construction, agri-tourism supply chains
Arnos Vale	Site of a new acute referral hospital, estimated at $110 million, which will significantly upgrade national healthcare capacity	Healthcare, construction, medical services
Bequia and Mustique	Established premium yachting and luxury-tourism destinations; Saint Vincent and the Grenadines accounts for around 36% of the Eastern Caribbean's yacht visitors	Yachting, marine services, boutique hospitality, villa real estate
Canouan	Exclusive island destination with high-end resort, marina and residential developments catering to the luxury market	Luxury tourism, marina services, high-end real estate
Union Island and the Southern Grenadines	Focus of reconstruction after Hurricane Beryl in 2024, creating demand for resilient housing, utilities and tourism facilities	Resilient construction, renewable energy and water, yachting

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Invest SVG (national investment promotion agency), led since April 2026 by Executive Director Anna Young, provides facilitation, incentive guidance and diaspora-investment outreach
- Fiscal Incentives Act (No. 5 of 1990), administered by the Department of Industry, granting import-duty concessions for qualifying enterprises over periods of 5, 10 or 15 years

- Hotel Aid Act (No. 16 of 1988), offering a 100% import-duty waiver on materials and equipment for hotel construction, expansion or improvement, available equally to nationals and non-nationals
- Investment-climate reforms under the new government: a proposed Investment Act guaranteeing fair and equitable treatment and non-discrimination, performance-based incentives, company registration in five business days and a planned online Business Gateway
- Eastern Caribbean Currency Union membership, with the Eastern Caribbean dollar fixed at EC$2.70 to $1 for 50 years and managed by the Eastern Caribbean Central Bank, removing exchange-rate risk for dollar-based investors
- Co-financing and partnership opportunities in infrastructure, resilience and energy alongside the Caribbean Development Bank, the World Bank and the UK Caribbean Infrastructure Fund

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Saint Vincent and the Grenadines enters late 2026 with a record tourism performance, a renewed investment agenda and transformed infrastructure. Real GDP grew 4.5% in 2024 and 3.7% in 2025, driven by tourism and construction, and the IMF projects 2.8% growth in 2026 with medium-term growth of around 2.7%; inflation averaged just 0.9% in 2025. Stayover arrivals reached a record 120,599 in 2025, up 17.4%, supported by new airlift into Argyle International Airport and new room stock from Sandals and others, while foreign direct investment reached 11.8% of GDP. The EC$720 million Kingstown Port opened in October 2025, and the New Democratic Party government elected in November 2025 under Prime Minister Godwin Friday has prioritised ease of doing business, including a new Investment Act, five-day company registration and performance-based incentives.

The country's main structural challenge is the combination of climate exposure and the public-debt legacy of recovery and investment. Hurricane Beryl in July 2024 caused damage of about $230 million, or 22% of GDP, and public debt stood at 113.1% of GDP in 2025 after successive reconstruction and capital programmes. The response has been practical and well supported: the World Bank's $63 million BERRy project was launched within three months, the government is reactivating its fiscal responsibility framework and establishing a fiscal council, and pension reform has extended the fund's life to 2060. Membership of the Eastern Caribbean Currency Union, whose reserve backing ratio stands at 97.6%, anchors monetary stability. For investors, the rebuilding and resilience agenda, including a target of 60% renewable energy by 2030, creates sustained demand for resilient construction, clean energy, water and tourism infrastructure.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Public debt and fiscal consolidation	Public debt reached 113.1% of GDP in 2025 after hurricane recovery and major capital projects, which will limit public co-investment in the near term	A reactivated fiscal rule, new fiscal council and expenditure review support consolidation, while creating room for private capital and PPP structures in infrastructure
Hurricane and climate exposure	Hurricane Beryl caused damage of about 22% of GDP in 2024, and the country remains exposed to Atlantic storms and volcanic activity	Build to resilient standards and secure parametric and conventional insurance; resilience investment is itself a growing opportunity backed by DFI financing
Small domestic market and import dependence	The current account deficit was about 20% of GDP in 2025, reflecting construction imports for hotel and infrastructure projects that are largely financed by FDI	Use regional CARICOM and OECS markets for scale; import-substitution opportunities exist in agro-processing and renewable energy
Airlift concentration	Long-haul access depends on a limited number of routes, and Delta's weekly Atlanta service ended in September 2026	American Airlines and JetBlue services continue from Miami and New York; tourism investors can work with government on route-development support
Administrative procedures	Investors have historically reported slow approvals and multiple-agency processes	The new government's reforms (five-day company registration, Business Gateway portal, single digital window) and Invest SVG facilitation are designed to shorten timelines

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Access to local finance	The banking system is dominated by one well-capitalised domestic bank with significant holdings of government debt, limiting private credit	Larger projects can draw on foreign banks, DFIs and regional lenders such as the CDB, with local credit unions serving smaller enterprises
Planned citizenship-by-investment programme	A CBI programme is being designed, with launch now floated for Q1 2027 at the earliest, and the IMF has highlighted reputational and AML/CFT considerations	Base investment cases on underlying project economics rather than CBI-linked demand, and apply enhanced due diligence to any CBI-related structures

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Saint Vincent and the Grenadines' risk profile reflects a small, open island economy that has delivered solid growth through successive shocks and is now converting a major public investment cycle into productive capacity: a modern port, an international airport attracting transatlantic and North American airlift, a new acute hospital and an expanding hotel base. The public-debt level of 113.1% of GDP is the principal macroeconomic consideration, and the IMF assesses the risk of debt distress as high and the debt as unsustainable without firm consolidation; the new government has committed to reducing debt, reactivating its fiscal rule and establishing a fiscal council, and concessional partners remain closely engaged. Climate exposure is a permanent feature of the operating environment, but the rapid, well-financed response to Hurricane Beryl demonstrates strong institutional and donor support. The fixed Eastern Caribbean dollar removes currency risk for dollar-based investors. Investors should build disaster and insurance planning into project design, and treat the planned CBI programme as a policy development to monitor rather than a source of demand.

MARKET ACCESS

Saint Vincent and the Grenadines is a member of the Caribbean Community (CARICOM) and its Single Market and Economy, of the Organisation of Eastern Caribbean States (OECS) Economic Union, and of the Eastern Caribbean Currency Union, giving investors a shared currency and regional market access across the Eastern Caribbean. It is a WTO member and, through CARIFORUM, a party to the Economic Partnership Agreement with the EU, while the US Caribbean Basin Initiative provides preferential access to the United States, the main market for its agricultural exports. Traditional exports include bananas, root crops such as dasheen and eddoes, arrowroot and fish, with regional markets in CARICOM offering diversification. The new Kingstown Port and Argyle International Airport significantly strengthen sea and air connectivity, supporting both trade and the tourism sector that drives the economy.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Office of the Prime Minister (Dr Godwin Friday, also Minister of Finance)	Leads the government elected in November 2025 and directs fiscal policy, private-sector development and investment-climate reform	Primary reference point for strategic direction and major project approvals
Invest SVG	National investment promotion agency, now with a dual mandate covering inward investment, export promotion and diaspora engagement	Standard first point of contact for market entry, incentives and facilitation
Eastern Caribbean Central Bank (ECCB)	Regional monetary authority managing the EC dollar peg and supervising banks across the currency union	Relevant for banking, currency and financial-sector matters
Saint Vincent and the Grenadines Tourism Authority	Leads destination marketing and airlift development for the country's principal growth sector	Key partner for hotel, resort and tourism-services investors
Saint Vincent and the Grenadines Port Authority	Operates the new Kingstown Port and co-financed its construction	Relevant for logistics, shipping and trade-related investment
Argyle International Airport	The country's international air gateway	Relevant for aviation services, logistics

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
	and the foundation of long-haul tourism access	and airlift-dependent tourism projects
Caribbean Development Bank and World Bank	Principal development partners, financing the port, hurricane recovery and resilience programmes	Potential co-financiers and partners for infrastructure, energy and resilience investments

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The Saint Vincent and the Grenadines Chamber of Industry and Commerce is the principal private-sector body for business liaison, while Invest SVG runs investor outreach, including its 2026 "Home is Where the Heart Is" diaspora investment tour across the UK, the British Virgin Islands and other markets, and works with the Centre for Enterprise Development on MSME support. The Caribbean Development Bank, the World Bank and the UK Caribbean Infrastructure Fund maintain active programmes in infrastructure, recovery and resilience, and are useful sources of project intelligence and co-financing. Sandals Resorts and other established hotel operators provide practical insight into tourism-sector logistics, labour and supply chains, and regional bodies such as the OECS Commission and the ECCB offer a wider Eastern Caribbean perspective.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Saint Vincent and the Grenadines suits investors seeking exposure to a fast-growing tourism destination with improving connectivity: resort and boutique hospitality developers building on record arrivals and new airlift; yachting and marine-services operators in Bequia, Mustique, Canouan and the Southern Grenadines; renewable-energy, water and resilient-construction firms supporting the 60% renewable target and post-Beryl rebuilding; and agro-processing investors serving tourism supply chains and regional markets. Infrastructure investors and DFIs are well placed to partner on PPP structures, and the Vincentian diaspora is an active and growing source of investment. Investors should build hurricane insurance and resilient design into project economics.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage Invest SVG and confirm available incentives
Open direct dialogue with the national investment promotion agency on Fiscal Incentives Act and Hotel Aid Act concessions and the new performance-based incentive framework.

STEP 2: Track the Investment Act and business-facilitation reforms
Follow progress on the proposed Investment Act, five-day company registration and the Business Gateway portal, which will shape investor protections and approval timelines.

STEP 3: Build climate resilience and insurance into project design
Apply resilient building standards and secure appropriate catastrophe cover, drawing on lessons from the Hurricane Beryl recovery.

STEP 4: Explore co-financing with development partners
Engage the Caribbean Development Bank, the World Bank and the UK Caribbean Infrastructure Fund on infrastructure, energy and resilience projects where public co-investment is limited.

STEP 5: Position for tourism and airlift growth
Work with the Tourism Authority on hospitality, yachting and supply-chain opportunities linked to new resort developments and route development at Argyle International Airport.